Casting and Announcement Timeline

Volume 15. **When each film, series and character was announced.** Real actors keep their real announcement dates. Each fictional actor is announced **in the same window as the real actor they replace**, so the real-world story follows the actual rhythm of Marvel's casting news. Dates marked **~** are approximate (month-level) and will be checked against the record when the story reaches them.

1. Infinity Saga Films: Key Casting

Character / project	Real history	
Iron Man: director	Jon Favreau, **Apr 28, 2006**	Same: our story starts that day
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Robert Downey Jr., **Sept 29, 2006**	**Marc-Anthony Bullock, Sept 29, 2006**
James Rhodes	Terrence Howard, ~Oct 2006; Don Cheadle (*Iron Man 2*), ~Oct 2008	Same (real casting history kept)
Obadiah Stane	Jeff Bridges, ~Jan 2007	Same
Pepper Potts	Gwyneth Paltrow, ~Feb 2007	**Tayia Boyd, ~Feb 2007**
Bruce Banner / Hulk	Edward Norton, ~Apr 2007 (Mark Ruffalo, **July 24, 2010**, Comic-Con)	**Amond Baker, ~Apr 2007**, who keeps the role from 2008 on, with no recast
Ant-Man (2009): Hank Pym and Janet van Dyne	No 2009 film in real life	**David Tipton and Elxa Bullock**, announced with Edgar Wright at **San Diego Comic-Con, July 2007**. Elxa's Janet cameo in *Iron Man* is filmed in secret before the announcement.
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	Scarlett Johansson, ~Jan-Mar 2009 (after Emily Blunt dropped out)	**Harmony Divine, ~Jan 2009**
Loki	Tom Hiddleston, ~Feb 2009	Same
Thor	Chris Hemsworth, ~May 2009	**Esther Smilley, ~May 2009**
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Chris Evans, ~Mar 2010	**Tyrese Avery, ~Mar 2010**
Bucky Barnes	Sebastian Stan, ~Apr 2010	**Tyler Chapman, ~Apr 2010**
Peggy Carter / Red Skull	Hayley Atwell, ~Apr 2010; Hugo Weaving, ~May 2010	Same
Hawkeye	Jeremy Renner, ~June 2010	**Arianna Cummings (Claire Barton)**: offered **June 15, 2010**, revealed live in Hall H on **July 24, 2010**
The Avengers cast on stage	**July 24, 2010**, San Diego Comic-Con	Same date, with our cast on stage
Star-Lord	Chris Pratt, ~Feb 2013	Same
Wanda and Pietro Maximoff	Elizabeth Olsen and Aaron Taylor-Johnson, ~late 2013 to early 2014	**Grace Bullock and Elijah Blackman, ~late 2013** (both 19)
Scott Lang	Paul Rudd, ~Dec 2013	Same
Vision	Paul Bettany, ~Feb 2014	Same
Thanos	Josh Brolin, ~2014 (Damion Poitier played him in the 2012 post-credits scene)	**Josh Brolin**, secretly filmed in 2011 and revealed on screen at the *Avengers* premiere, **April 11, 2012**. Even the cast didn't know.

Character / project	Real history	
Black Panther, Captain Marvel and the Phase Three slate	**Oct 28, 2014**, Marvel's El Capitan event (Chadwick Boseman revealed)	Same date
Doctor Strange	Benedict Cumberbatch, ~Dec 2014	Same
Spider-Man	Tom Holland, **June 23, 2015**	Same
Carol Danvers	Brie Larson, **July 23, 2016**, Comic-Con	Same
Nadia van Dyne	(Hope van Dyne: Evangeline Lilly, ~Jan 2014)	**Yara Shahidi, ~July 2017**, at the *Ant-Man and the Wasp* Comic-Con panel

2. Multiverse Saga: Key Announcements

Event	Real history	
Phase Four slate (Comic-Con)	**July 20, 2019**: *Shang-Chi* (Simu Liu), *Eternals*, *Thor: Love and Thunder* (Natalie Portman as Mighty Thor), *Blade* (Mahershala Ali), and the first Disney+ series	Same date. Jane joins as a second Thor alongside Esther.
Streaming slate expo	**Aug 23, 2019**: *Ms. Marvel*, *Moon Knight*, *She-Hulk*	Same date, at Donohue's fan expo (D23 in real life)
Investor Day	**Dec 10, 2020**: a wave of series and films	Same date (Donohue Investor Day)
Kang the Conqueror	Jonathan Majors, ~2020; fired **Dec 18, 2023**	Same
Phase Five and Six slate (Comic-Con)	**July 23, 2022**: *The Kang Dynasty*, *Secret Wars*, *Fantastic Four*	Same
The Fantastic Four	Pedro Pascal, Vanessa Kirby, Joseph Quinn, Ebon Moss-Bachrach, **Feb 14, 2024**	Same
Doctor Doom	Robert Downey Jr., **July 27, 2024**, Comic-Con	Same: “Doom was always the endgame”
Avengers: Doomsday cast reveal	**Mar 26, 2025** livestream	Same, with Marc-Anthony's Tony Stark in the lineup

Phase Announcements (LOCKED)

Phase	Announced	How
Phase One (2008-2012)	Never formally	Feige began calling the first films "Phase One" in interviews in 2011-2012, after the fact. Includes our 2009 *Ant-Man*.
Phase Two (2013-2015)	**Sat, July 14, 2012**, Comic-Con, Hall H	*Iron Man 3*, *Thor: The Dark World*, *Captain America: The Winter Soldier*, *Guardians of the Galaxy*, *Ant-Man* (our sequel, with Scott Lang taking over the suit), *Avengers 2*. The *Age of Ultron* title follows at Comic-Con on July 20, 2013.
Phase Three (2016-2019)	**Tue, Oct 28, 2014**, Marvel event at the El Capitan	Nine films, including *Civil War*, *Black Panther* (Chadwick Boseman revealed), *Captain Marvel* and *Infinity War*
Phase Four (2021-2022)	**Sat, July 20, 2019**, Comic-Con, Hall H	Expanded on Aug 23, 2019 at Donohue's fan expo and on Dec 10, 2020 at Donohue Investor Day

Phase	Announced	How
Phases Five and Six (2023-2027)	**Sat, July 23, 2022**, Comic-Con, Hall H	Both phases at once, and the first use of the name "The Multiverse Saga." *The Kang Dynasty* is later retitled *Avengers: Doomsday* on July 27, 2024.

3. Series Leads (Marvel Television: full canon)

Series	Lead casting announced
Agents of S.H.I.E.L.D.	Clark Gregg's return, ~2012
Agent Carter	Hayley Atwell, ~May 2014 (series order)
Daredevil	Charlie Cox, ~May 2014
Jessica Jones / *Luke Cage*	Krysten Ritter and Mike Colter, ~Dec 2014
The Punisher (introduced in *Daredevil* season 2)	Jon Bernthal, ~June 2015
Iron Fist	Finn Jones, ~Feb 2016
Donohue+ series (*WandaVision*, *Falcon and the Winter Soldier*, *Loki*, *Hawkeye*)	Announced **July 20, 2019** (Comic-Con) and **Aug 23, 2019** (fan expo). Our leads: Grace Bullock, Tyler Chapman with Anthony Mackie, Tom Hiddleston, and Arianna Cummings with Hailee Steinfeld.

A real-world story note: every one of these dates is a chapter waiting to happen: leaks the night before, agents' phone calls, Comic-Con crowds, message-board meltdowns, and Desmond Smilley reading the trades.